I did this exercise a few times prior to some big games in my career. I'm not going to say which ones. But it really helped. Unfortunately, I wasn't disciplined enough, so I didn't do it regularly. I was careless. It's carelessness that is my biggest enemy. Who knows, I could've been a better player had I done this visualization exercise more often and consistently.

Of course, that's just one trick. You know what helps the most on the field? Confidence. It's amazing. Heaps and tons and loads and droves of it. The more, the better. I admit, I may have just a bit of it. It helps one out in many – no, most – parts of the game, even life. But overconfidence – that's fatal. It can make you slip up. It can trigger your greatest defeats.

Imagine this. You're batting. You're feeling the pressure but ignoring it. You think you're believing in yourself. But what you're not doing is getting your focus straight. You're overconfident and not observant enough. You're looking at the bowler. You're thinking he's mediocre. You're thinking he's no good. You're focusing on his past, on his stats, on the last time you knocked him around and out of the park but you're not thinking of the present threat that he poses.

You're overconfident. You don't see him coming. And you're out in the blink of an eye.

Overconfidence kills. Avoid it. All the time.

Here's the thing about Pakistan. We stop well. Or we lash out well. Thus, we do well in Tests and excel in T20s. That's the irony. Unfortunately, we are suffering in ODIs. We can't pace ourselves. We can't keep our cool. We can't turn off, switch on, go into hyperdrive and go back to cooling off. We can't finish. We can't sustain ourselves. That's our ODI gap.

It's about practice, too. You find yourself in all sorts of situations in an ODI, all within a single day. I don't think Pakistan is playing enough ODIs, to begin with. And no, it's not about captaincy. It's not about Azhar Ali versus Sarfaraz Ahmed. We have to let the new skipper have a go. We can't have these younger guys on probation all the time.

See, cricket has changed. T20 is awesome. But it's blamed for quick money and instant gratification. It's blamed for commercialization. The purists hate it. But the evolution of the game is important. Everything must change. Cricket must change and will continue to change whether the old-schoolers like it or not. That's just the way things are.

In a Test match, chances are that you can tell by the third day what's going to be the outcome. In a T20 game, you usually can't predict a winner till the last ball is bowled. You just don't know, and that's what makes the format a force to reckon with. It's like the movies. You move on with technology, right? You can't just stick to the same old sets and the black-and-white silver screen, just because it is classy and reminds you of the good old days. You have to change production methods. You have to deal with the green screen. Look at what people have achieved with CGI (computer-generated imagery). Cricket is the same.

Also, it doesn't matter what form of cricket you play, you have to stay fit. I've learnt this the hard way. You see, I'm strong. I always was. But crossing forty is not something I'm taking for granted. Upper body, lower body, cardio, core – I mix it up, every day. Or else I'll get bored. I travel a lot but still keep my trainers and gym clothes on me. I do in thirty-five minutes what other guys do in one hour. When my body gets really sore, I swim. It opens me up and relaxes me.

Once upon a time, I used to eat everything. I avoid bread and rice nowadays. I also eat only with a fork! I don't play golf. I don't do ski vacations or beach resorts. I go home, to my wife and